Language Choice in Education

GS II

- India's education system promotes multilingual learning because knowledge of different languages can improve communication and cultural understanding. However, students enter schools with different **linguistic backgrounds**. A uniform language requirement may create difficulties when learners have limited exposure to the language they are expected to study.
- Introducing an additional language late in a student's schooling can increase **academic pressure**. Students may need time to learn unfamiliar vocabulary, grammar and writing skills. Making such a language part of a major examination can disadvantage learners who have not received adequate preparation.
- Language policy must distinguish between encouraging multilingualism and imposing compulsory learning requirements. The National Education Policy 2020 supports multilingual education while emphasising **flexibility in language choices**. Effective implementation should consider student preferences, teaching resources and differences between regional education systems.
- English and Indian languages serve different educational and professional purposes. English can support access to international communication and employment, while regional languages strengthen cultural connections and local learning. A balanced approach should expand **language opportunities** without unnecessarily restricting students' academic choices.

Language education should encourage multilingual abilities while respecting student choice, regional diversity and learning readiness. Flexibility makes language policies more inclusive and educationally effective.

Foreign Intervention and State Stability

GS II

- Foreign military intervention may weaken or overthrow an existing government, but removing political leadership does not automatically create effective institutions. When administrative structures and security arrangements collapse, the resulting **power vacuum** can make it difficult to restore order and provide essential public services.
- Political instability can intensify when different religious, ethnic or armed groups compete for authority. Without an **inclusive political settlement**, communities may distrust one another and form competing organisations. Such divisions can prolong conflict even after the original government has been removed.
- External powers may establish military bases or support local security forces to maintain influence after intervention. However, **prolonged foreign involvement** can generate resistance among groups that view it as interference. This may strengthen armed movements and complicate efforts to build legitimate national institutions.
- Lasting stability requires institutions capable of maintaining security, resolving political disputes and representing diverse communities. Military operations alone cannot achieve these goals. **Political reconciliation**, accountable governance and locally accepted arrangements are necessary to reduce the risk of renewed conflict.

Foreign intervention may change political leadership, but durable peace depends on legitimate institutions, inclusive governance and political reconciliation rather than military power alone.

Rising Global Borrowing Costs

GS III

- Governments borrow money by issuing bonds that promise investors future payments. When investors demand higher returns for lending, **government bond yields** rise. This increases the cost of new borrowing and can make refinancing existing debt more expensive when it matures.
- Persistent **fiscal deficits** increase governments' borrowing requirements because expenditure exceeds revenue. Large debt burdens, inflation concerns and uncertainty about future economic policies can make investors demand higher yields. As borrowing costs increase, governments may have less financial flexibility for public spending.
- Government bond yields influence borrowing costs throughout the economy because they serve as **reference rates** for other financial instruments. Higher yields can increase financing expenses for businesses and households, potentially discouraging investment, consumption and economic expansion.
- Rising global interest rates can affect emerging economies through **capital movements** and changing investor preferences. Countries may face pressure to maintain attractive financial returns while supporting domestic growth. Sound fiscal management and careful monetary policy coordination become important for maintaining economic stability.

Higher government bond yields can raise debt-servicing costs and restrict economic activity. Managing fiscal pressures and financial stability becomes essential when global borrowing conditions tighten.